- How well is your team working together?
- Are your estimations accurate?
- Are your tasks appropriately sized?
- How much is your team really getting done?

then you should use the following tips to ensure you're generating the richest set of data you can.

Changing SCM in the enterprise

As I talk about generating rich data in the next few sections, I'll be talking through potential changes to how your team operates that might not seem realistic. If you're working at a nimble startup or are about to start a new project, then choosing or changing the type of SCM you use may not be a big deal. If you're from a large enterprise company that has used CVS forever and refuses to hear anything about these newfangled SCM systems, a good data point to use to justify changing systems is the amount of data you can get out of them and how they can improve collaboration on your team. If you find yourself in that situation, keep that in mind as you read through the following sections.

4.2.1. Tip 1: Use distributed version control and pull requests

There are plenty of options when it comes to choosing a version control system to use. When you do choose a system, think about the type of data that you can get out of it as part of its overall value. The first choice to make when choosing an SCM system is whether to go with a distributed or a centralized system. A centralized system is based on a central server that's the source of truth for all code. To make changes and save the history of them, you must be connected to the central repository. A centralized SCM system is shown in figure 4.3.

Figure 4.3. Centralized SCM system: there is one place everyone must get to.